
UNDP
DRIVING
IMPACT
through
PARTNERSHIPS
ANNUAL REPORT 2024

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Foreword

2024 has been a year marked by growing regional crises that reverberated far beyond the country's borders. The ongoing war in Gaza and Sudan have caused immense human suffering and had serious socio-economic and humanitarian consequences for neighboring countries, including Egypt.

As a key actor in the Arab region and the African continent, Egypt has demonstrated leadership and resilience; managing the spillover effects, including increased demands on public services, disrupted trade flows, and heightened pressures on host communities.

In this context, the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) in Egypt remained committed in its support to the Government of Egypt, working alongside national stakeholders and international development partners to deliver meaningful results. Together, we advanced Egypt's green, inclusive economic growth, social cohesion, and climate action.

To help inform national and regional responses, UNDP's Rapid Assessment Report on the potential socio-economic impact of the Gaza war on Egypt, provided detailed scenario-based projections on how the conflict could further strain Egypt's economy. The study offered insights for policy makers to mitigate risks and strengthen resilience in the face of ongoing uncertainty.

Our joint programmes in 2024 also facilitated 69,000 microloans, enabling nearly 17,000 job opportunities and strengthening local economies. We provided support to communities affected by regional displacement, including those hosting Sudanese refugees, through emergency employment programmes that created 9,000 labor-day opportunities, injecting EGP 2.5 million into the local economy.

UNDP also scaled up youth-led green innovations and helped connect more than 1,400 enterprises to high-quality digital services.

In the renewable energy space, UNDP installed over 200 megawatts of solar capacity in public institutions in the last decade, including schools and hospitals, and established a solar desalination unit in Nabq protectorate, ensuring sustainable access to drinking water. This builds on our ongoing portfolio, which over the years has consistently supported Egypt's clean energy transition. This also aligns with Egypt's target of achieving 35% of electricity generation from renewables by 2030, as outlined in its Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs).

To prioritize climate resilience, we continued our support to protect Egypt's coastlines through an Integrated Coastal Zone Management Plan and the design of an Early Warning System to reduce climate-related risks.

At the global level, we played an important role in shaping digital, urban, and financing dialogues. We were proud to support Egypt in hosting the first-ever Global Digital Public Infrastructure Summit, fostering global cooperation on inclusive and secure digital transformation.



By working together, we continue to support a more inclusive, green, and resilient development pathway.

UNDP also led the development of Egypt's Integrated National Financing Strategy (E-INFS), under the umbrella of the Integrated National Financing Framework (INFF); a key initiative that aims to bridge financing gaps for the SDGs and unlock sustainable investments. Our contributions also extended to global platforms such as the Global Congress on Health, Population and Human Development and the World Urban Forum.

These achievements, detailed throughout this Annual Report 2024, demonstrate the power and potential of strong partnerships in the face of complexity and crisis. By working together, we continue to support a more inclusive, green, and resilient development pathway.

As we move through 2025, we are already implementing our newly developed Country Strategic Note (2025–2027), which provides a clear roadmap for scaling up innovation, deepening inclusion, and driving resilience.

I extend my heartfelt thanks to our partners, government, donors, civil society and communities. Your continued trust and collaboration make these achievements possible.

Alessandro Fracassetti
UNDP Resident Representative in Egypt
United Nations Development Programme

Key Highlights 2024

Digital Transformation and Innovation

Egypt hosted the
GLOBAL DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE SUMMIT

Egypt Post evolves into
FINANCIAL HUB

1,400+
enterprises gained access
to quality and reliable **digital services** (including digital infrastructure)

42
persons with disabilities supported
with **job placements & digital training**

1,039
individuals trained
in **digital citizenship**

65+
MSMEs accessed
new markets including via **e-commerce**



Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise (MSME) Empowerment and Entrepreneurship

85,955
MSMEs financed
and **119,980 beneficiaries** received non-financial services

69,061
microloans disbursed (EGP3.4B)
equally to women and men

252,000+
jobs created
through public works and **training programmes**

44,000+
people capacitated
with **entrepreneurship skills**

4,000
enterprises supported
with **increased inclusion** in value chains

US$28+ MILLION
mobilized
through **direct/facilitated investments** for supported startups

2,000+
women entrepreneurs empowered
via **“Heya Raeda”** & **“Qodwa Tech”** programmes

5,000
freelancers trained
and supported from different governorates via **Creativa Innovation Hubs**

US$9 MILLION
secured in investments
for green SMEs **via the Green Growth and Jobs Accelerator Programme (GGJAP)**

52
green enterprises showcased
at a national conference

Social Protection and Health

17,388 OUT OF 22,619
of the key populations
reached/accessed **HIV Testing Services**

HIV outreach doubled – expanding from 3 TO 8 governorates,
reaching more key populations

Enhanced diagnostic capabilities by expanding the number of **GeneXpert Machines** and enabling the programme to utilize WHO-recommended Rapid Diagnostic Tools.

2,518 people from TB key vulnerable groups
(including migrants and refugees), **were identified and enrolled in treatment**

NINE
NGOs contracted
to **implement economic empowerment activities** and have successfully disbursed

869 loans to Takaful and Karama programme beneficiaries
(780 women, 89 men and 132 PwDs) in **8 governorates**



Environment, Energy and Nature

FIVE
public buildings equipped



with solar power, **cutting 250 tons of emissions yearly**

215KW
of off-grid solar power installed



for **52 homes and 850 LED streetlights** in Sharm El-Sheikh, reducing emissions

Developed **oceanographic monitoring systems and an Early Warning System** to protect coastal zones from sea-level rise and extreme weather events



Solar-powered desalination plant built
8 m³/day



of **clean water** for local communities

655
Ozone Depleting Potential (ODP)



phased out with eco-friendly alternatives in **insulation foam production**

Installed **solar-powered desalination units** in Nabq Protected Area, providing clean water to local communities



Biodiversity financing unlocked -
beekeeping & crafts boost local incomes by
25%



SIX
industrial and organic clusters launched,



enhancing local resilience & **promoting eco-friendly economic growth**

Promoted sustainable income through **community-based natural resource management**, including beekeeping in Wadi El Gemmal





Governance

Impact of Gaza War on Egypt socio-economic assessment released

Integrated **National Financing Strategy** developed and launched

Tax for SDGs initiative – UNDP provides tax policy support and capacity building support to Ministry of Finance and Egyptian Tax Authority

Developed **National Monitoring and Evaluation Manual** for the Ministry of Planning, Economic Development and International Cooperation

Launched a **Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning Diploma** for the Institute of National Planning





Local Development and Resilience

15
training programmes delivered
to **558 local leaders**

38,725
home visits
and **6 community health campaigns** conducted in refugee-hosting areas

Rural tourism mapped
through **a policy review** linking rural development, sustainable tourism and national initiatives

The roadmap for National Decentralization Strategy
has been **developed and endorsed** by Minister of Local Development

Comprehensive review
of all policies and strategies impacting **rural tourism in Egypt** was conducted

Impact

Digital Transformation and Innovation

In today's interconnected world, digital transformation is no longer a luxury—it is a public good. UNDP Egypt has worked at the forefront of this shift, supporting the Government of Egypt in building inclusive, secure, and future-ready digital ecosystems that empower people, expand opportunity, and drive sustainable development.

As a trusted partner to the Ministry of Communications and Information Technology (MCIT), **UNDP has adopted a whole-of-society approach to digital transformation—engaging government institutions, the private sector, civil society, and communities.** Our work in 2024 focused on bridging the digital divide, enhancing digital governance, human capital development and accelerating the adoption of digital public infrastructure (DPI) to ensure that all segments of society can benefit from technological advancement.

A GLOBAL MOMENT: Egypt hosts the DPI Summit

In a milestone achievement, Egypt hosted the first-ever Global Digital Public Infrastructure Summit, co-organized by UNDP, co-develop, the World Bank, and the International Telecommunication Union. With participation from over 100 countries, the summit produced a powerful "Call to Action," reaffirming DPI's role as a critical enabler of the SDGs.

The summit's outcomes were echoed at the highest levels of global leadership, including the G20 Troika Declaration on Digital Public Infrastructure, Artificial Inteligence, and Governance—marking Egypt as a global thought leader in inclusive digital transformation.

FROM VISION TO ACTION: Scaling digital impact

Tangible digital dividends are now evident on the ground. Over 1,400 enterprises have gained improved access to digital services, helping them expand their operations and enhance competitiveness. Sixty-five MSMEs successfully tapped into new markets through e-commerce, and more than 44,000 individuals received entrepreneurship training to strengthen their digital and business capabilities.

In parallel, Egypt Post is evolving into a modern financial hub, expanding its services and outreach—particularly in rural and underserved areas—through its vast network of 4,400 branches. Targeted initiatives also delivered specialized support for more than 2,000 women entrepreneurs, facilitated 42 job placements for persons with disabilities, and equipped over 1,000 participants with digital citizenship skills, including youth and educators.

1,400+
enterprises gained access
to quality and reliable **digital services**

65+
MSMEs accessed
new markets including via **e-commerce**

DIGITAL AT THE GLOBAL STAGE

UNDP supported Egypt's presence at high-level platforms including the UN General Assembly and the Summit of the Future. The Minister of ICT highlighted Egypt's digital progress at UNDP's "Digital Future for All" panel and the AI for Sustainable Development ministerial roundtable, spotlighting advances in the health and justice sectors.

Regionally, Egypt demonstrated leadership by co-hosting UNDP's "Enabling a Digital Arab States Region" event during the UN General Assembly. UNDP also convened key stakeholders at the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS), where Egypt's national AI model was presented as a regional case study during the roundtable on "Harnessing AI for the SDGs in the Arab Region."

Empowering Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises and Entrepreneurship

The competitiveness, scalability, and resilience of MSMEs are crucial to Egypt's private sector growth. In partnership with the Government of Egypt, UNDP has been working to strengthen MSMEs through creating an enabling environment that fosters financial inclusion, improves access to finance, and supports re-skilling programmes for long-term growth.



IMPACT STORY

MSMEDA and UNDP strengthen Egypt's MSME Sector: A partnership for growth and resilience

The partnership between UNDP and the Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprise Development Agency (MSMEDA) has deep roots, beginning in 1991 when MSMEDA was first established as the Social Fund for Development. **Over the years, UNDP has played a key role in guiding MSMEDA through crucial transitions, significantly enhancing its ability to support Egypt's MSME sector.**

Since October 2021, the partnership has seen remarkable progress. The project has expanded MSMEDA's capacity, transforming its functions, strengthening the MSME ecosystem, and leveraging digital innovation to boost efficiency and resilience in the face of economic shocks.

MSMEs are the backbone of Egypt›s economy, representing 98% of the private sector, with 3.8 million businesses operating across the country. These enterprises are more than just numbers—they are the hopes and dreams of entrepreneurs striving to build better futures for themselves, their families, and their communities. Beyond their economic contributions, MSMEs are pivotal in fostering social development, providing jobs to marginalized communities, and addressing local needs. Empowering these enterprises is a core part of the mission to ensure no one is left behind.

In 2024, significant progress was made to support Egypt's MSMEs. **UNDP's collaboration with MSMEDA led to the disbursement of 69,061 microloans, totaling 3.4 billion EGP**, which were equally distributed between men and women, fueling the growth of small businesses across the country.

In addition to financial support, UNDP and MSMEDA worked together to provide vital non-financial services. **More than 81,861 entrepreneurs, including 42,361 men and 39,500 women, benefited from over 20 different services aimed at expanding their businesses and enhancing their capabilities.** This support also extended to developing six organic and industrial clusters, which further strengthened local economies and promoted sustainable growth.

These joint initiatives also contributed to **local job creation, with 86 public works and training projects being implemented, which engaged 5,805 trainees and created over 252,000 jobs.** These efforts are not only improving livelihoods but also bolstering the resilience of communities to economic fluctuations and external shocks.

69,061
microloans disbursed (EGP3.4B)
equally to women and men

252,000+
jobs created
through public works and **training programmes**



FEATURE HIGHLIGHT: Scaling green MSMEs through GGJAP

Supported by the Danish-Arab Partnership Programme (DAPP) and the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Denmark, GGJAP is empowering sustainable futures, UNDP Egypt and Denmark's Green Growth and Jobs Accelerator project is working to drive local transition towards a green economy, empowering youth led innovations, creating green jobs for women and youth.

In 2024, the programme helped six green SMEs become investment-ready, resulting in five confirmed investment deals worth $9 million. Four enterprises participated in international investor events, while 52 SMEs were showcased at the national Green Growth Conference. The event received broad media coverage and catalyzed exposure, fundraising, and customer engagement.

GGJAP also enhanced strategic business development, delivering tailored support to SMEs in branding, packaging, and planning. This helped several expand into regional markets, including the Gulf. In partnership with the Ministry of Youth and Sports and Plan International, GGJAP supported the Youth for Sustainability (Y4S) programme, which launched five youth-led green initiatives. Each initiative received seed funding of EGP 100,000 to transform initial ideas into early-stage, impact-driven businesses. These initiatives addressed critical environmental and social challenges and equipped young leaders with the tools, mentorship, and exposure needed to become catalysts for change in their communities.

Social Protection and Health

In times of crisis and uncertainty, inclusive social protection and accessible health services become essential to safeguarding human dignity and accelerating human development. In 2024, UNDP Egypt continued to work alongside national partners to expand equitable access to healthcare, improve social safety nets, and empower vulnerable populations—especially women, youth, persons with disabilities, and migrants.

Our approach focused on integrated, people-centered programming that strengthened institutional capacities, advanced community-based solutions, and supported Egypt's commitment to leaving no one behind.



EXPANDING HIV PREVENTION AND TREATMENT

UNDP supported the National AIDS Programme in expanding community-based HIV services to eight governorates—up from three in the previous cycle. These efforts reached 22,619 individuals from key populations, of whom 17,388 (77%) accessed HIV testing services. With the help of WHO-recommended diagnostics and GeneXpert machines, 2,518 from TB key vulnerable groups, including migrants and refugees, were identified and enrolled in treatment.

17,388 OUT OF **22,619** **of the key populations**

reached/accessed **HIV Testing Services**

HIV outreach doubled – expanding from 3 TO 8 governorates,

reaching more key populations

With the help of WHO-recommended diagnostics and **GeneXpert machines,**

2,518 people from TB key vulnerable groups

(including migrants and refugees), **were identified and enrolled in treatment**

FROM PROTECTION TO PRODUCTION

UNDP works with nine NGOs to implement economic empowerment activities across eight governorates—Asyut, Sharqeya, Beheira, Beni Suef, Giza, Minya, Sohag, and Qena—successfully disbursing 869 loans to beneficiaries of the Takaful and Karama programme, including 780 women, 89 men, and 132 persons with disabilities (PwDs). Beneficiaries have established a range of diverse livelihood projects spanning animal husbandry, poultry farming, garment and home textile production, various handicrafts (such as carpets and metal accessories), soap and detergent production, as well as commercial and service-oriented businesses, including bakeries, grocery stores, beauty salons, carpentry, and local transportation services.

Environment, Energy and Nature

As climate change accelerates, Egypt is responding with bold, integrated action across energy, biodiversity, water, and resilience systems. In 2024, UNDP Egypt continued to work closely with the Ministry of Environment and key partners to advance Egypt's green transition—through technical assistance, policy innovation, and community-driven solutions.

Our focus was twofold: helping Egypt mitigate and adapt to climate risks while promoting nature-based development that enhances livelihoods, conserves biodiversity, and sustains long-term growth.



SCALING CLEAN ENERGY AND RESILIENT INFRASTRUCTURE

UNDP provided technical and implementation support for Egypt's clean energy goals through the installation of over 200 kW of solar capacity across public buildings, including schools and hospitals, cutting annual emissions by an estimated 250 tons. In the Nabq Protected Area, a solar-powered desalination unit now produces 8 m^3/day of clean water for local communities.

In Sharm El-Sheikh, 52 homes were equipped with off-grid solar systems and 850 LED streetlights were installed, reducing reliance on fossil fuels and improving public safety. At the industrial level, UNDP supported Egypt in phasing out 655 tons of ozone-depleting substances from insulation foam production, reinforcing its compliance with global environmental standards.

Solar-powered desalination plant built

8 m^3/day

of **clean water** for local communities

215KW
of off-grid solar power installed

for **52 homes and 850 LED streetlights** in Sharm El-Sheikh, reducing emissions

PROTECTING COASTAL ZONES AND ENHANCING BIODIVERSITY

With Egypt's coastal areas increasingly threatened by sea-level rise and extreme weather, the Ministry of Water Resources and Irrigation, with UNDP and the Green Climate Fund (GCF)'s support, the 'Enhancing Climate Change Adaptation in the North Coast of Egypt' project developed an Integrated Coastal Zone Management (ICZM) Plan and designed new Early Warning Systems using oceanographic data to guide risk mitigation efforts. These tools are essential in safeguarding vulnerable populations and infrastructure in the Nile Delta and Red Sea regions.

Biodiversity financing and natural resource management also saw progress in 2024. Community-led activities in Wadi El-Gemal, such as beekeeping and handicrafts, generated sustainable income for local families—boosting business revenues by 25% and empowering women in conservation. Management plans were also developed for Nabq and Ras Mohamed, strengthening ecosystem stewardship and protected area financing.

PROTECTING COASTAL ZONES AND ENHANCING BIODIVERSITY

UNDP Egypt's Accelerator Lab, co-funded by the Qatar fund for Development and Germany, explored scalable system innovations to address food insecurity, climate resilience, and green entrepreneurship:

- **Urban Farming:** A series of collective intelligence workshops co-organized with International Organization for Migration (IOM) brought together stakeholders to explore urban agriculture as a solution for climate-resilient, decentralized food systems.
- **Coastal Tourism:** Intra-African Sustainable Coastal Tourism: A series of virtual collective intelligence workshops, co-organized with ADDL-Innet, brought together African stakeholders to explore designing a platform that stimulates Intra-African Sustainable Coastal Tourism as a solution for Climate Change Vulnerabilities.
- **Cinema for Awareness:** Creative foresight work identified arts and cinema as powerful tools for rural climate education, especially across African communities.

In partnership with the UNDP Futures Portal, the Lab published "Seeding the Future: Transforming Agriculture in Egypt's Nile Delta", a knowledge product on climate-smart crops and strategic foresight. Another initiative, "Future Fit Accelerator", in partnership with "Future Fit Solopreneur" startup & the BUE, used behavioral insights to explore what motivates young women to pursue green jobs, producing an impactful video that captured personal transformation through exposure to green tech and entrepreneurship.

FEATURE HIGHLIGHT:

From COP27 legacy to local action: Advancing climate leadership

With support from a $6 million multi-partner initiative, funded by the European Union, the African Climate Foundation, the Climate Emergency Collaboration Group, and the Governments of Denmark and Switzerland, UNDP partnered with Egypt's COP27 Presidency from the start, Egypt's COP27 Presidency to turn global commitments into national momentum. **This partnership helped Egypt strengthen its leadership on climate diplomacy—training over 700 delegates, promoting African climate priorities across 10 global platforms, and advancing operationalization of the Loss and Damage Fund.**

At home, the Green Sharm Initiative made Egypt's climate ambition tangible: solar installations now power hospitals, museums, and public lighting; medical waste is being sustainably managed; and local communities, particularly women and youth, have been empowered through nature-based livelihoods, craft marketing, and eco-tourism. From mangrove rehabilitation in Nabq to youth-led Smart Green Projects, this initiative bridged climate ambition with action, community engagement, and global influence.

IMPACT STORY

Egypt's green transition accelerates toward a sustainable future

Egypt is making transformative steps toward sustainability by integrating environmental and social factors into its growth. Sharm El-Sheikh has emerged as a leader in this green transformation, serving as a model for sustainable urban development. Solar power systems have been installed at King Salman University, five public schools, and the Ras Mohamed Protected Area, including an 80-kW solar station at the university. These efforts exemplify Egypt's shift toward greener, more resilient infrastructure.

Beyond Sharm El-Sheikh, Egypt's transition to clean energy has gain momentum nationwide over the recent years. **The shift to energy-efficient lighting has led to the sale of over 300 million LED lamps, reducing electricity consumption by 10-15%.** UNDP has continuously supported Egypt in this transition, making it a key contributor to the country's clean energy efforts. Meanwhile, rooftop solar power installations continue to expand across various sectors, including airports, convention centers, schools, and hotels.

Biodiversity conservation remains a key priority to protect Egypt's natural heritage. Through the Global Biodiversity Framework Early Action Support (GBF-EAS), Egypt has advanced policies for ecosystem protection, with local communities playing an active role in conservation. Management plans for protected areas like Nabq and Ras Mohamed have been developed, supported by strengthened funding mechanisms. **In Wadi El-Gemal, sustainable income-generating activities such as beekeeping and handicrafts have boosted local business revenues by 25%** in 2024, empowering women and reducing reliance on environmentally harmful industries.

At the industrial level, efforts to combat pollution are accelerating. In 2024, 655 tons of ozone-depleting substances used in insulation foam production are being phased out, contributing to climate action goals.

Building resilience to climate change is also a core focus. In 2024, new systems are being developed to monitor oceanographic conditions, laying the foundation for an Early Warning System to mitigate the impacts of sea-level rise and extreme weather events. These initiatives ensure that Egypt is addressing current challenges and preparing for future climate risks.

A holistic approach to sustainable development is shaping Egypt's policies. The Integrated Coastal Zone Management Plan, introduced in 2024, ensures balanced development along the North Coast by involving all relevant stakeholders. This approach reflects a broader commitment to sustainable, people-centered growth, prioritizing both environmental and social factors.

As Egypt continues its green transition, strong partnerships remain central to advancing sustainability goals, strengthening climate resilience, and shaping a cleaner, more sustainable future.

Governance and Sustainable Financing

Effective governance and robust public financing systems are foundational to achieving sustainable development. In 2024, UNDP Egypt continued its long-standing collaboration with national institutions to strengthen transparency, accountability, public service delivery, and the mobilization of resources for the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

Working closely with the Ministry of Planning and Economic Development, the Ministry of Finance, and the Egyptian Tax Authority, UNDP provided policy, technical, and institutional support to help Egypt optimize development financing—especially in a context shaped by regional conflict and economic volatility.



A MILESTONE FOR FINANCING THE SDGs

Egypt became the first country in the region to launch an Integrated National Financing Framework (INFF)—a bold step in aligning public and private finance with national development objectives. UNDP provided technical leadership throughout the INFF process, supporting policy formulation, stakeholder consultation, and capacity building. This framework is now guiding the mobilization of sustainable financing, enhancing coordination across ministries, and fostering innovation in financing mechanisms.

TAX POLICY REFORM: From revenue to impact

Under the global Tax for SDGs initiative, supported by the Government of Finland, UNDP worked with Egypt's Ministry of Finance (MoF) and the Egyptian Tax Authority (ETA) to draft key inputs for Egypt's National Tax Strategy (2025–2030). This included a zero-draft of carbon tax legislation, policy options for carbon pricing, and training for MoF and ETA officials on climate finance and SDG 13.

UNDP also conducted capacity-building trainings for ETA tax auditors on the auditing of State-Owned Enterprises—helping strengthen domestic resource mobilization and transparency.

FEATURE HIGHLIGHT:
Impact measurement and management

UNDP accelerated and built the capacities of 75 participants from the private sector and financial institutions on Impact Measurement and Management, following UNDP's SDG Impact Standards. The trainings focused on 2 major Venture Capital funds that invest into leading startups in Egypt, a masterclass derived from a partnership with Ministry of Planning directed to green startups and SMEs, one of Egypt's biggest holding private sector companies, & finally to the biggest French companies in Egypt in partnership with the French Embassy.



RESULTS-BASED GOVERNANCE AND MONITORING

In partnership with the Ministry of Planning, Economic Development and International Cooperation, UNDP supported the development of a National Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Manual, which was developed in 2024. The manual provides a practical framework for results-based management and is being rolled out across government entities.

To institutionalize monitoring as a core governance function, UNDP and the Institute of National Planning also launched Egypt's first Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (MEL) Diploma. The program equips public officials with the tools to assess development performance and improve service delivery based on real-time evidence.

These achievements reflect UNDP Egypt's sustained effort to embed transparency, efficiency, and long-term planning into the country's governance and public financing systems—ultimately ensuring that development resources are more effectively directed toward the people who need them most.

Local Development and Resilience

Resilient communities are at the heart of sustainable development. In 2024, UNDP Egypt deepened its collaboration with the Ministry of Local Development (MoLD), local authorities, and civil society to advance decentralization, promote rural development, and deliver more responsive services to citizens.

Our efforts focused on strengthening the institutional architecture for local governance while addressing the unique development challenges facing Egypt's governorates—particularly those most vulnerable to climate shocks, displacement pressures, and economic volatility.



ADVANCING DECENTRALIZATION AND LOCAL GOVERNANCE

UNDP supported the development of the roadmap of Egypt's Decentralization Strategy. The roadmap—endorsed by the Minister of Local Development—outlines clear roles and responsibilities for local actors and enhances coordination between national and subnational levels.

In parallel, 14 tailored training programmes were delivered to 519 local administrative leaders, building skills in strategic planning, participatory governance, and climate-responsive development.

To support long-term planning, UNDP, with the support of the European Union, helped the Ministry replicate best practices from the Upper Egypt Local Development Program and conducted a pilot rural development study in Qena and Luxor, assessing the sustainability of investments made through the Hayah Karima (Decent Life) initiative.

15
training programmes delivered
to **558 local leaders**

The roadmap for National Decentralization Strategy
has been **developed and endorsed** by Minister of Local Development

LINKING TOURISM, HERITAGE, AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT

Rural tourism emerged as a key opportunity to connect local economies to national development strategies. In 2024, UNDP completed a comprehensive policy review on rural tourism, focusing on how it intersects with sustainable tourism, local development, and Egypt's broader economic inclusion agenda. The review also identified opportunities to align tourism development with climate adaptation and community empowerment, especially in Upper Egypt and Sinai.

By anchoring local development in community needs and inclusive governance, UNDP's work is helping Egypt build resilient, responsive, and future-ready local systems.

IMPACT STORY

Strengthening Resilience in Host Communities – The Alexandria Model

As part of UNDP's support to communities affected by displacement, a joint pilot with the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise Development Agency (MSMEDA) and Alexandria Governorate was launched to bolster the resilience and livelihoods of host communities impacted by the Sudanese refugee crisis.

The initiative focused on two key components:

1. **Labor-intensive infrastructure development:** Rehabilitation of the Al-Mandarah Family Health Unit created 1,467 workdays for 31 unskilled and semi-skilled workers, improving local health infrastructure while providing income-generating opportunities.
2. **Community-based health services:** In partnership with the Family Planning Association in Alexandria and the Ministry of Health, this component generated 8,368 workdays (out of a planned 13,300). Sixty female health promoters and supervisors were hired and trained. They conducted over 38,725 home visits, benefiting 5,600 Sudanese and Egyptian families and supporting the rollout of three mobile clinics, which reached an additional 5,618 individuals. Furthermore, six health campaigns were implemented, raising awareness of preventive health practices and improving household-level health outcomes in vulnerable communities.

38,725
home visits
and **6 community health campaigns** conducted in refugee-hosting areas

60
female health promoters and supervisors
were **hired and trained.**



Crisis Response and Recovery

In a region impacted by instability, Egypt has emerged as both a first responder and a development anchor. In 2024, UNDP worked with the Government of Egypt and local partners to support crisis-affected communities—especially those impacted by the ongoing war in Gaza and the spillover from the Sudanese conflict.

UNDP's approach to crisis response is rooted in development. Rather than reacting to emergencies in isolation, we invest before, during, and after crises—strengthening systems, building local capacities, and promoting recovery that is inclusive, sustainable, and resilient.



HEALTH, INFRASTRUCTURE, AND RESILIENCE IN HOST COMMUNITIES

UNDP scaled up support in communities hosting refugees, notably in Alexandria and Aswan:

- In Alexandria, a joint UNDP–MSMEDA initiative rehabilitated the Al-Mandarah Family Health Unit, generating over 1,467 workdays for local workers.
- A health outreach component created over 8,000 workdays for 60 female health promoters, who conducted nearly 39,000 home visits and supported the deployment of three mobile clinics, reaching more than 5,600 people.
- In Aswan's Karkar village, labour-intensive activities to rehabilitate a health unit created 2,200 workdays, while 33 trained health promoters reached 3,000 families with home visits focused on maternal and child health.
- UNDP provided essential support to the Egyptian Red Crescent (ERC) amid the Gaza war, supporting humanitarian interventions. This partnership facilitated the timely procurement and targeted distribution of critical medical supplies, including surgical instruments, bandages, syringes, and gloves. Additionally, operational effectiveness improved through the acquisition of 12 walkie-talkies, enhancing frontline coordination. Collectively, these actions reinforced emergency response capabilities and underscored a firm commitment to supporting resilience among displaced populations in Gaza.

Karkar village health unit renovated benefitting

2,000+

33
trained health promoters reached

3,000 families with home visits focused on **maternal and child health.**

Capacity-building initiatives trained

25
volunteers in Cairo on Volunteer Management.

30
volunteers in Ismailia

in Emergency and Flood Response.

Reallocating

250,000EGP
expedited aid transportation to affected communities.

PEACEBUILDING AND CLIMATE SECURITY

Cairo International Center for Conflict Resolution, Peacekeeping, and Peacebuilding (CCCPA), marked 30 years of advancing peace and security across Africa. In 2024, two new regional projects were launched with support from the Governments of Switzerland and the Netherlands: “Enhancing Regional Responses to Africa’s Emerging Peace and Security Challenges” and “Enhancing African Capacities for Combating Human Trafficking and Smuggling of Migrants”, with UNDP support.

CCCPA also advanced the COP27 Presidency Initiative on Climate Responses for Sustaining Peace (CRSP). This initiative bridges the gap between peacebuilding and climate action by addressing climate-displacement, food security, adaptation, and access to climate finance.

UNDP continued to serve as institutional partner to the Aswan Forum, while CCCPA participated in high-level global dialogues such as the Munich Security Conference and the Stockholm Forum. Over 600 peacekeepers received pre-deployment trainings, and targeted capacity-building was delivered for 33 government officials on trafficking and border security in South Sudan.



IMPACT STORY

CCCPA Marks 30 Years of Advancing Peace and Security Across Africa

The Cairo International Center for Conflict Resolution, Peacekeeping, and Peacebuilding (CCCPA) celebrated a significant milestone in 2024, marking its 30th anniversary of dedicated efforts toward peace and security. For three decades, the CCCPA has been a driving force in promoting peacebuilding, conflict prevention, and regional stability, both within Africa and beyond.

The Center’s work spans across critical areas including peacekeeping, women, peace and security, combatting transnational threats, climate security, conflict prevention, demobilization, disarmament, reintegration, and youth, peace and security. Since 2008, UNDP has partnered closely with CCCPA to address regional challenges, bringing technical expertise and support to strengthen these efforts.

In 2024, two key projects have been launched to tackle emerging peace and security challenges in Africa with funding from the government of Switzerland and Netherlands.

Additionally, UNDP continues to serve as the institutional partner for the Aswan Forum, a platform dedicated to championing African-led solutions to complex security and development challenges, and UNDP remains the Institutional Partner

In the area of climate security, CCCPA has taken bold steps with the development of the COP27 Presidency Initiative titled “Climate Responses for Sustaining Peace (CRSP).” Recognizing that climate change poses a significant peace and security challenge, CRSP seeks to bridge the gap between climate action and peacebuilding and ensuring that integrated climate responses contribute to sustainable peace and development in line with national ownership and context specificity.

The initiative focuses on four key pillars: strengthening the climate-adaptation-peacebuilding nexus, Sustaining Peace through Climate-Resilient Food Systems, advancing durable solutions to the climate displacement nexus, and mobilizing climate finance for sustaining peace.

CRSP is not only a framework but a call to action to ensure women, youth, and local communities play an active role in shaping climate responses.

As part of its global engagement, CCCPA has played a key role in several high-level platforms, including the Munich Security Conference and the Stockholm Forum for Peace and Development.

Through training programs for African policymakers, CCCPA continues to bridge knowledge gaps and strengthen policy responses, further cementing its role in advancing peace and security in Africa.

KNOWLEDGE PRODUCT SPOTLIGHT
Gaza War's Economic Impact on Egypt

A new rapid assessment released by UNDP sheds light on the significant socio-economic effects of the ongoing Gaza conflict on Egypt's economy. The analysis, titled "Potential Socio-Economic Impact of the Gaza War on Egypt: A Rapid Assessment," examines the multiple ways in which the war is straining Egypt's economic reform efforts and development trajectory, with projections under three scenarios: low-intensity (six-months), medium-intensity (nine-months), and high-intensity (one-year).

The study estimates that Egypt's GDP could fall by 2.6% in the fiscal year 2023–24 and 1.3% in 2024–25 in a medium-intensity scenario. In a high-intensity scenario, the losses could be even more pronounced, with GDP declining by 3.0% in 2023–24 and 2.6% in 2024–25. The unemployment rate is expected to increase, with the medium-intensity scenario projecting a rise to 8.7%, and the high-intensity scenario seeing it climb to 9.1%, up from the current rate of 7.8%.

The assessment also highlights the severe impact on Egypt's key sources of revenue, including tourism and Suez Canal revenues. The conflict has disrupted maritime transit and regional stability, leading to estimated losses of approximately $9.9 billion in revenue for fiscal years 2023-24 and 2024-25 under the medium-intensity scenario. If the war escalates, this figure could reach $13.7 billion.

The rapid assessment underscores the need for targeted measures and policy reforms to ensure Egypt's socio-economic stability. The Egyptian government has already signed several agreements to increase foreign currency inflows and capital, with a focus on restoring macro-financial stability. Policy recommendations from the study include strengthening support for vulnerable populations, implementing labor market reforms, and promoting regional economic cooperation.

As Egypt navigates these challenges, the report highlights the urgent need for coordinated efforts to mitigate the economic impact of the Gaza war and pave the way for a sustainable recovery.

Unemployment rate expected to increase
8.7%

in the medium-intensity scenario and **9.1%** in the high-intensity scenario.

$9.9 BILLION
estimated losses due to ongoing gaza conflict

on **tourism and Suez Canal revenues** for fiscal years 2023-24 and 2024-25.



Egypt's Global Leadership and Impact

In 2024, Egypt continued to play a leadership role in shaping global and regional conversations on sustainable development, urban resilience, climate action, and youth empowerment. Through strategic participation in high-level international platforms—with UNDP's support—**Egypt advanced bold, forward-looking solutions while amplifying the voice of the Global South.**

WORLD URBAN FORUM 12: Cities at the heart of development

At the World Urban Forum 12 (WUF12), Egypt shared its experience in managing rapid urbanization, addressing housing needs, and promoting sustainable infrastructure—drawing particular attention to the New Administrative Capital project as a model for inclusive and climate-resilient city planning.

UNDP supported Egypt's participation and policy positioning at the Forum, offering technical input on urban resilience, local governance, and green infrastructure. Egypt's contributions underscored the importance of integrated urban development strategies to achieve the SDGs.

COP29: Shaping climate security and youth leadership

At COP29 in Baku, Egypt stood out as a leading voice on climate security and inclusive climate governance. UNDP co-organized ten strategic events with the Government of Egypt, focused on:

- Digital innovation for sustainability
- Youth-led green entrepreneurship
- Circular economy and climate finance
- Regional cooperation on climate-induced migration and water scarcity

A key moment came during the Closing Session of the COP29 Simulation, organized by the British University in Egypt and UNDP and implemented in cooperation with ADA University (Azerbaijan). **22 youth delegates were selected from among 160 students representing 88 universities—delivered a powerful youth declaration.** The proposals closely mirrored the final COP29 outcome on the New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG), highlighting the COPSimulation's accuracy and value in preparing young negotiators.

The COP29 Simulation is supported by the Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research, and the Ministry of Youth and Sports, with the continued support of the Egyptian Presidency of COP27. COP29 Simulation gathered around 160 students from 88 universities across 44 countries, including 22 Egyptian institutions, fostering global climate dialogue and policy advocacy.

UNDP also supported Egypt's participation in ministerial panels, including a spotlight on the role of women in STEM and the green economy, showcasing partnerships such as the Future Fit Accelerator with the British University in Egypt.

COP16 AND BEYOND: From advocacy to action

At COP16, Egypt championed the call for increased financial support for developing countries to address climate risks and implement the Paris Agreement. Egypt advocated for equitable access to funding, technology transfer, and stronger capacity-building frameworks.

UNDP contributed by facilitating expert dialogues, building institutional capacity, and mobilizing financing pipelines aligned with biodiversity and resilience goals. The UNDP Accelerator Lab, in partnership with the Egyptian Food Bank, also hosted a foresight session on Africa's agrifood systems—highlighting emerging opportunities in urban farming, coastal tourism, and cinema for climate awareness.

STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIPS: A preferred government partner

Partnerships are the foundation of UNDP's ability to deliver impact at scale. In 2024, UNDP Egypt continued to serve as a trusted partner to the Government of Egypt and deepened its collaboration with development partners, international financial institutions, civil society, academia, and the private sector.

These partnerships ensured that support to national priorities was coordinated, responsive, and focused on results. Together, we advanced climate action, digital transformation, social protection, local development, and inclusive governance.

UNDP's alignment with Egypt Vision 2030 and the Government Programme remained central to its value as a development partner. Across ministries—from Foreign Affairs, Planning, Economic Development and International Cooperation to Environment, Communications and Information Technology, Finance, Social Solidarity, and Local Development—UNDP offered policy support, technical assistance, and capacity strengthening.

Key government institutions and national initiatives including MSMEDA, the National AIDS Programme, the National Council for Women, CCCPA, and the Hayah Karima Initiative—benefited from UNDP's integrated and adaptive programming model.

STRONG AND DIVERSE INTERNATIONAL SUPPORT

UNDP's work was made possible through the continued support of a diverse range of development partners, including:

- Bilateral partners such as the Governments of Japan, Italy, Denmark, Switzerland, France, the Netherlands, and Spain
- Multilateral institutions including the European Union, Agence Française de Développement (AFD) and the African Development Bank
- Vertical funds and foundations such as the Global Environment Facility (GEF), the Green Climate Fund (GCF), the Global Fund for Coral Reefs, the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria, and the Big Heart Foundation
- United Nations agencies that collaborated through joint programming and the UN Cooperation Framework

UNDP also continued to strengthen engagement with the private sector, universities, and innovation hubs to unlock new resources and ideas.

Together, these partnerships enabled the design and delivery of integrated solutions that address complex development challenges, whether expanding green jobs, scaling digital services, or supporting communities through crisis.



UNDP Egypt's 2025 Priorities

TOWARDS A GREEN AND INCLUSIVE DEVELOPMENT

Together with our partners, we are committed to shaping a more inclusive, sustainable and green Egypt.

As we move forward, UNDP remains committed to driving inclusive growth, innovation, and resilience across Egypt. Our Country Strategic Note 2025-2027 aligns with national priorities, **focusing on six key programme areas:**

01 **Digital Transformation & Innovation –** Advancing Egypt's "Digital Egypt" agenda, strengthening AI capabilities, and promoting anti-corruption and governance reforms.

02 **Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprise (MSME) Development & Entrepreneurship –** Supporting Egypt's private sector growth through financial inclusion, digitalization, and skills development, with a strong emphasis on youth- and women-led businesses.

03 **Social Protection & Health –** Addressing poverty through data-driven policy solutions, expanding digital health services, and reinforcing national efforts against HIV, TB, and other health challenges.

04 **Environment & Energy –** Supporting conservation, sustainable tourism, climate resilience, and Egypt's transition to clean energy through policy innovation and public-private partnerships.

05 **Governance –** Enhancing transparency, accountability, and integrity in public administration while fostering an environment that attracts sustainable investment.

06 **Local Development & Resilience –** Strengthening decentralization, empowering communities, and ensuring sustainable development solutions for host communities and forcibly displaced populations.

Across all our work, youth, gender equality, persons with disabilities, private sector engagement, innovation and South-South cooperation **remain at the heart of our approach.**

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UNDP works with over 170 countries and territories to build a better future. This report highlights the development results UNDP achieved in 2024. With the support of our partners, we have helped millions of people around the world to improve their lives.